



Police Merit Commission Meeting September 4th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IriuMoNP0Yw
Publication Date	2025-09-04T22:15:12Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer at 6:03 p.m. [00:00:30](#)
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Chuck, Chris, Steve Craig, and Mark Sloan (along with the presiding officer and other board members responding to roll call).
 - **Members Absent:** None explicitly noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Board President (name not explicitly stated).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Not mentioned in the transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - [00:00:45](#) Motion made and seconded to approve the meeting minutes from July 17, 2025.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:01:38](#) **Police Department Business: Promotion of Sergeant Gareth Vanata to Lieutenant**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Police Chief.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The Police Chief requested to fill three open lieutenant positions from the current candidate list. For the first vacancy, the Chief nominated Sergeant Gareth Vanata. A board member moved to accept the promotion, which was seconded. The Chief then shared Vanata's professional background, noting he was hired on June 16, 2003 (in his 23rd year), and has served as a patrol officer, field training officer, DARE officer, traffic team leader, crash reconstructionist, and uniform sergeant since January 14, 2017.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:04:20 Police Department Business: Promotion of Sergeant Joseph Duckham to Lieutenant**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Police Chief.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Continuing to fill the second lieutenant vacancy, the Police Chief nominated Sergeant Joseph Duckham from the candidate list. A motion was made and seconded to approve the promotion. The Chief highlighted Duckham's background: hired on January 2, 2018 (in his eighth year), served as a patrol officer, field training officer, detective, hostage negotiation team member (since 2020), and was promoted to sergeant in December 2022. He served as a midnight road supervisor until November 2024, after which he supervised the smart unit and domestic violence unit. The Chief also noted Duckham's family law enforcement background, including his father serving as the police chief at Ball State University.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:06:46 Police Department Business: Promotion of Sergeant Justin Peters to Lieutenant**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Police Chief.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** To fill the third and final open lieutenant position, the Police Chief nominated Sergeant Justin Peters. A motion and second were made to approve the promotion. The Chief presented Peters' background, noting he was hired on June 5, 2006 (in his 20th year), and has served in patrol, as a field training officer, K-9 officer, dive team member and leader, honor guard member and leader, and uniform sergeant since August 18, 2020. The Chief also noted that Peters' wife is a tenured member of the department.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion carried by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No open public comment period or citizen remarks occurred during the meeting.*

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Attorney Mark Irvin was noted as not present. No other administrative reports or upcoming meeting dates were announced.
 - **Adjournment:** A motion and second were made to adjourn the meeting.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion carried by Voice Vote.
 - **Adjournment Time:** Official adjournment at 6:14 p.m. [00:09:51](#)
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